IT Acceptable Use Policy

Scope

This policy covers every computer, phone, tablet and network service provided by the organisation, and any personal device that is used to reach organisational systems. It applies to employees, contractors and visitors who are given access.

Approved devices

All company laptops must conform to the Copper Finch device standard, which requires full-disk encryption, an up-to-date operating system and the endpoint protection agent installed by the IT team. Devices that do not meet the standard are blocked from the corporate network until they are corrected.

Passwords and access

Passwords must be at least twelve characters and may not be reused across systems. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, the document repository and any system holding personal information. Credentials must never be shared, even with colleagues.

Reporting incidents

Lost or stolen devices, suspected phishing messages and any unexpected access to files must be reported to the service desk immediately. Early reporting allows the security team to disable accounts and limit the harm.

Additional guidance

Exceptions to it acceptable use policy require written approval and are kept on file so that they can be checked during an audit. Staff are expected to follow the arrangements for it acceptable use policy and to ask their manager when they are unsure how a rule applies to their situation. Where it acceptable use policy affects customers or the public, the responsible team must make sure the wording is clear, consistent and easy to find.

Review and ownership

Exceptions to it acceptable use policy require written approval and are kept on file so that they can be checked during an audit. Staff are expected to follow the arrangements for it acceptable use policy and to ask their manager when they are unsure how a rule applies to their situation. The owner of it acceptable use policy reviews it at least once a year and records any change, together with the date and the reason for the change.